

OHIO HIGH SCHOOL ATHLETIC ASSOCIATION

4080 Roselea Place, Columbus, OH 43214

Sports Regulations Bulletin: Concussion Protocol and Eligibility

Bulletin 2026 to 2027, Number 3. Revised and posted October 1, 2026. Applies to all member schools for the remainder of the 2026 to 2027 school year. This revision updates the return to play timeline in Section 2.

Athletic directors and head coaches must confirm receipt.

Section 1. Concussion Recognition and Removal

Any athlete who exhibits signs or symptoms consistent with a concussion shall be removed from practice or competition immediately and shall not return that day. Removal is mandatory and is not subject to coach or parent discretion. Both a referee and a coach may initiate removal.

Section 2. Return to Play

An athlete removed for a suspected concussion may return only after written clearance from a physician (MD or DO) or a licensed athletic trainer working in consultation with a physician. The graduated return to play protocol must span a minimum of five days, increased this cycle from the prior minimum, with no more than one stage advanced per day, and a stop and rest if symptoms recur.

Section 3. Baseline Testing

Member schools are strongly encouraged to administer preseason baseline neurocognitive testing for contact sport athletes. Westfield and all Columbus City League schools participate through the district athletic trainer. Baseline results are retained in the athlete's file for two seasons.

Section 4. Academic Eligibility

To be eligible, a student in grades 9 through 12 must have received passing grades in a minimum of five one credit courses in the immediately preceding grading period. Eligibility is checked at the end of each nine week grading period. A student who fails to meet the standard is ineligible for the next grading period.

Questions on this bulletin should be directed to the OHSAA Sports Medicine office. Coaches are reminded that the protocol is a floor, not a ceiling. When in doubt, sit them out.